Akbar almost a personal affront. There were further reasons for Akbar's impatience with his khankhanan. According to Badauni, Akbar was not even allotted a sufficient privy purse and his own servants were kept in a niggardly fashion whereas Bairam Khan's servants were rich and had been generously promoted. A number of historians blamed the supposedly pernicious effect Maham Anaga was having on the relationship between the Padshah and his ataliq; she was accused of having too much ambition herself. Nizamuddin Ahmad grumbled in his *Tabaqat-i-Akbari* that 'at every opportunity they said to His Majesty…words which might produce disfavour in his mind [towards Bairam Khan] especially Adham Khan, who on account of his being the son of Maham Anka, had precedence over all who were specially favoured, and always in concert with his mother followed the path of envy.' However, Abu'l Fazl maintained that it was Akbar, instead, who discussed the matter with Maham Anaga, 'who was a marvel of sense, resource and loyalty'. As a result of this and other discussions at court, the Padshah decided that he would assume sovereignty and inflict suitable punishment on Bairam Khan.

In March 1560, having consulted with Maham Anaga, Akbar left Agra for Delhi on the pretext of visiting Hamida Banu who was at that time residing in Delhi. He was, instead, initiating a well-calculated coup against Bairam Khan. Akbar's entire foster family were clearly active participants since, in addition to Maham Anaga, her son and son-in-law also arrived in Delhi as did Ataka Khan from the Punjab. A farman* was also sent to Munim Khan in Kabul, where he had been waiting ever since Bairam Khan had murdered Tardi Beg. As news spread of Bairam Khan's fall from grace, the nobility and soldiers quickly displayed their loyalty by riding to Delhi so that the entire army was soon gathered there. An agitated Bairam Khan tried to send messengers to Akbar who refused to entertain them and, instead, sent a letter to his regent:

> For reassuring you, we had written that though there may arise a quarrel between father and son, yet neither can be indifferent to each other. Since you are our Khan Baba, the same relationship applies between us. In spite of this grief and hurt and improper and unworthy acts (from you) we hold you in our affection and favour and love you. We still call you and recognise you as 'Khan Baba' as in the past.